DAVIDE TAGLIALATELA

taglialatela@fas.harvard.edu
Cell 857-999-6862
davide-taglialatela.github.io

HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Littauer Center
1805 Cambridge St
Cambridge MA 02138

Placement Director: Myrto Kalouptsidi myrto@fas.harvard.edu 617-495-2144
Placement Director: Oleg Itskhoki itskhoki@fas.harvard.edu 617-495-2144
Administrative Director: Brenda Piquet bpiquet@harvard.edu 617-495-8927

Education

Harvard University
Ph.D. Economics, 2020 to 2027 (expected)
Bocconi University, Italy
M.Sc. Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 cum laude, 2020
B.Sc. Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 cum laude, 2017
Princeton University
Visiting student, 2017

Fields

Financial Economics
Behavioral Economics
Climate Finance

References

Professor Xavier Gabaix
Harvard University
xgabaix@fas.harvard.edu

Professor Andrei Shleifer
Harvard University
shleifer@fas.harvard.edu

Professor Marco Sammon
Harvard Business School
msammon@hbs.edu

Professor Adi Sunderam
Harvard Business School
asunderam@hbs.edu

Fellowships, Grants & Awards

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard Griffin GSAS, 2026–2027
Molly and Domenic Ferrante Economics Research Fund, 2026
Ross Garon and Anna Suh Family Foundation Economics Research Fund, 2025
Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center, Harvard University, 2022, 2023
Bocconi Graduate Merit Award, Bocconi University, 2017

Teaching

Teaching Fellow, Harvard University
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Daniel Graves, 2026
Corporate Finance (undergraduate), Daniel Bergstresser, 2025
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Weiling Liu, 2025
Quantitative Methods in Economics (undergraduate), Davide Viviano, 2025
Capital Markets (undergraduate), Xavier Gabaix and Matthew Pritsker, 2023
Psychology and Economic Theory (Ph.D.), Matthew Rabin, 2022, 2023

Research

Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Andrei Shleifer, 2022–2025
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Matthew Rabin, 2021
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Stefanie Stantcheva, 2019–2020
Research Assistant, Harvard University, Professor Alberto Alesina, 2018
Visiting Student, IGIER, Bocconi University, Professor Francesco Giavazzi, 2018–2020

Job Market Paper

What a Disaster Means: Attention, Interpretation, and the Demand for Green Assets

How does the interpretation of an event shape portfolio responses, flows, and prices? I examine how locally supplied interpretations shape which investors respond and the assets they choose to hold. I use natural disasters as a setting in which a common physical event receives different interpretations across affected places. Using large language models fine-tuned to classify nearly 1.5 million articles from U.S. news outlets, combined with circulation data, I construct a new measure of local interpretation that distinguishes attention to a disaster from coverage explicitly linking it to climate change. I combine this measure with geographically identified portfolios of household-serving advisers and mutual fund managers. Among disaster-affected counties, stronger climate interpretation of local coverage leads to substantial reallocation toward green ETFs in the portfolios managed by household-serving advisers, about 20% of pre-event green-ETF holdings per ten percentage points of interpretation over two quarters. Mutual fund managers within 50 miles tilt their active trading toward greener firms as climate-linked disaster coverage rises, while the volume of coverage alone does not. I further confirm the causal effect of locally supplied interpretation using changes in the ownership of the county's outlets: under a larger owner the climate-interpreted share of local disaster coverage is lower, holding coverage constant. At the national level, disaster interpretation is associated with higher flows into green funds, conditional on attention. In a counterfactual in which disasters activate the institutional investor base, an interquartile increase in climate interpretation implies a relative appreciation of green stocks equal to 15.2% of the observed annual green return spread.
[Latest draft available here]

Seminars & Conferences

2025: New England Economics Ph.D. Conference (Brown University)

Graduate Summer Schools

Deep Learning for Dynamic Stochastic Models, University of Turin, 2025
Large Language Models in Finance; NLP and Large Language Models, Barcelona School of Economics, 2025
Computational and Experimental Economics, BESLab, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, 2023
Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money and Finance, Princeton University, 2022
Behavioral Finance, Yale University, 2022
Summer Institute in Behavioral Economics, Russell Sage Foundation, 2022
Text as Data, Barcelona School of Economics, 2021
Random Graphs and Complex Networks: Structure and Function, Bocconi University, 2019
Tools for Macroeconomists: Advanced Tools, London School of Economics, 2018

Languages

Italian (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)

Software skills

R, MATLAB, Python, JavaScript (for Qualtrics applications), Excel, Visual Basic for Excel, and Access (International Computer Driving Licence, Advanced Certificate, 2016)

Personal information

Citizenship: Italian